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The ITC Grand Bharat in Manesar, Haryana. Beginning at the design stage, steps are taken at all ITC Hotels to ensure that energy, water and solid waste efficiencies are maximised

are integrating revised energy efficiency targets and design features into the construction standards of those hotels already in the pipeline. In parallel, we have begun an extensive study into how our current design and construction practices can be modified to minimise emissions for both operational and embodied carbon,” says Jain.

At Raffles Udaipur, the first Raffles hotel in India that opened last year, sustainability is also about maintaining the environment around the property. Set on a 21-acre island in the middle of Udai Sagar Lake, it becomes imperative that steps are taken to ensure that the lake is not polluted. The property has an

STP and all sewage water is recycled for irrigating its 17 acres of gardens, with no waste water going into the lake. To not impact the flora and fauna in the lake, home to several migratory birds, a battery-operated boat brings the guests from the mainland to the property. It runs on a fixed path where disturbance is least. “We are a zero-waste property,” says Ritesh Mudgal, Resort Manager of Raffles Udaipur. To cut down on plastic, the hotel has shortlisted vendors who provide grains and spices in jute and cloth bags. “The idea is to avoid plastic coming on to the island,” he says.

Giving back to the community is a key aspect of sustainabil-

ity. For instance, Ananda in the Himalayas recently set up a not-for-profit institute in Rishikesh to provide free spa training to underprivileged girls. Aashica Khanna, Vice President of IHHR that runs the wellness resort, says: “Sustainability has to be addressed from various angles whether it is waste, community, eco-sensitivity, conscious consumption, etc. It’s an overall ecosystem that you need to create.”

With luxury travellers demanding and willing to pay for it, sustainability is no longer just a catchphrase, but fundamental for luxury hospitality players. **BT**

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